A-A-51456A
7 March 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51456
30 May 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBE, CENTRIFUGE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-T-36886A.

This commercial item description covers a non-sterile, disposable, plastic centrifuge tube suitable for use in laboratory procedures that include centrifuging.

Salient characteristics:

Shall be a non-sterile, graduated, disposable, 50 milliliter (mm) capacity conical bottom centrifuge tube with screw cap closure.

Shall be suitable for use in laboratory procedures that include centrifuging. Shall be able to withstand a relative centrifugal force (RCF) of 5800 g. The tube shall not break when used in a centrifuge(e.g., Damon/IEC Model DPR 6000) operating at full speed.

The tube shall be fabricated of translucent polypropylene. The screw cap shall be fabricated of polyethylene or polypropylene.

The tube shall have nominal dimensions of 30 millimeter (mm) outside diameter X 115 mm long. The configuration of the tube shall be suitable for centrifuging by insertion in a 50 ml sealed dome shield (e.g., Damon/IEC Cat. No. 324, or equal) having a 29.5 mm inside diameter X 101 mm length, and includes an insert with a conical concavity and a top mounted screw-on dome cap.

The tube shall include volumetric markings that are permanent and legible. The graduation markings shall include 2.5 ml increments from 5.0 to 10 ml and 5 ml increments from 10 to 50 ml.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

As a minimum, the incremental markings from 5.0 to 45 ml shall be numbered. There shall be a suitable indication that the numbering represents "milliliter" or "ml" volumetric capacities. The volumetric accuracies of the graduation markings shall be as indicated in table I.

TABLE I. Volumetric accuracy.

Graduation(s)	Tolerance (Plus or Minus ml)
0 to 5 ml graduation	0.75
above 5 ml to 10 ml	1.00
above 10 ml to 30 ml	1.50
above 30 ml to 50 ml	2.00

The top of the tube shall be threaded to accommodate the screw cap closure. The screw cap should be capable of being hand-tightened to the tube to form a watertight (leakproof) fit with the tube. The maximum allowable outside dimensions of the screw cap shall be 36 diameter X 12 depth (mm), to preclude interference with proper closure of a dome cap with a centrifuge tube shield.

Workmanship. The tube and screw cap closure shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 500 tubes with caps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements. The sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice.

Volumetric accuracy. At least one graduation from each range included in table I shall be tested to determine its volumetric capacity. The testing shall be conducted in accordance with NBS 602 (Testing of Glass Volumetric Apparatus) as applicable for "to contain" flasks and cylinders. Any tube having volumetric capacities that do not conform to allowable capacity tolerances specified in table I, shall be cause for rejection.

Leakage. A tube shall be filled to the 50 ml graduation mark with water containing a dye. A screwcap shall be secured hand-tight to the tube. The tube with screwcap closure in place shall be inverted and set on a flat surface and allowed to stand for one hour. As an alternate, the inverted tube shall be subjected to a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (mg) for one minute. The inverted tube shall then be inspected for any evidence of leakage in the form of water appearing between the screwcap and the tube. Any tube with evidence of leakage shall be cause for rejection.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-00-054-7460 TUBE, CENTRUFUGE

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL ENGINEERING COORDINATION ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS

Project No. 6640-1481
Location: Disk #4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4066 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
Attn: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51456A	TUBE, CENTRIFUGE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording.

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.